

The First Caliph Abu Bakr

Abu Bakr, the first Caliph, was given the title 'Siddiq' by the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH). Siddiq means 'The Testifier to the Truth.' Before embracing Islam, Abu Bakr was a respected and wealthy merchant in Mecca. He was among the first to accept Islam when the Prophet invited his closest friends and relatives. During the early days of Islam, Abu Bakr endured persecution alongside the small group of Muslims. When the Prophet emigrated from Mecca to Medina, Abu Bakr accompanied him on the dangerous journey. In the battles during the Prophet's life, Abu Bakr was always by his side. He once donated all his belongings for the defense of Medina, leaving only God and His Prophet for his family. He was well known for his upright character, compassion, and kindness to the poor. Abu Bakr lived simply and used his wealth for charity, freeing slaves, and supporting Islam.

Muslims festivals

Muslims celebrate two main festivals: Eid-al-Fitr and Eid-ul-Adha. Eid-al-Fitr, the Festival of Fast-Breaking, occurs on 1 Shawwal after Ramadan, while Eid-ul-Adha, the Festival of Sacrifice, is on 10 Dhul-Hijja following Hajj. When the Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) arrived in Medina, he replaced the existing pagan festivals with these two Eids, meant for thanksgiving and rejoicing. Eid-al-Fitr marks the end of Ramadan, first celebrated in Medina after the Prophet's migration. Eid-ul-Adha marks the completion of Hajj, emphasizing acts of worship. Eids are times for spiritual joy, not for frivolity or excess, and focus on prayer, almsgiving, and social visits. Eid prayers are held between sunrise and noon in congregation, with women having the option to pray at home. The Eid prayer includes two rakats with additional takbirs and a sermon highlighting charity and sacrifice. During Eid-ul-Adha, pilgrims sacrifice sheep or cows at Mina, distributing the meat among the poor and keeping some for personal use. Sacrifices can be made on Eid day or the following two days, with a portion of the meat given to the poor and as gifts to friends and relatives.

The childhood and youth

Muhammad (saw) was born in 570 in Mecca to a single mother, Amina, after his father's death. Being of noble blood, he was cared for by a Bedouin wet nurse named Halima. She took him to live in the desert. This harsh environment helped him develop a deep connection with nature and a habit of contemplation. After returning to his mother, they visited his father's grave, but Amina fell ill and died on the return journey when Muhammad (saw) was only six. This early loss influenced his compassion for orphans, later encouraging kindness towards them. Muhammad (saw) then lived with his grandfather Abdul Muttalib for two years until his death. After the death of his grandfather, he moved in with his uncle Abu Talib. As a young boy, Muhammad (saw) worked as a shepherd, a role he later spoke of fondly, noting that all prophets were shepherds. He became well-known for his honesty in business and trade, earning a reputation for his fair dealings.